

F5 Daily Briefing – Thursday, July 02, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

18

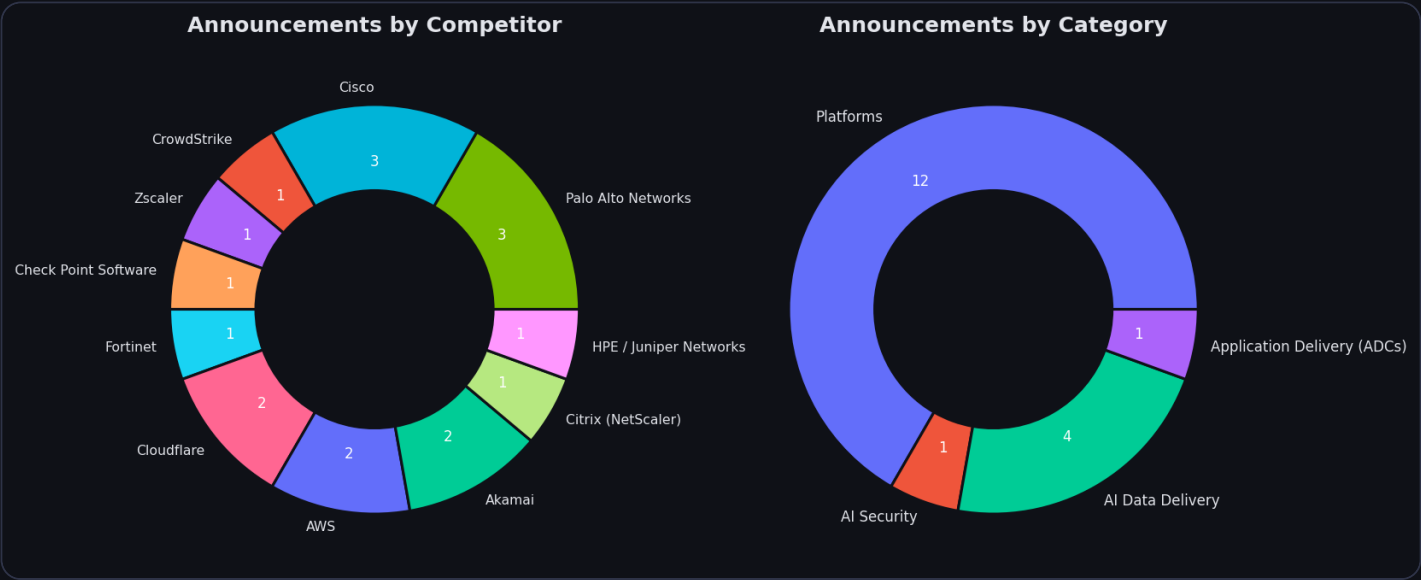
ANNOUNCEMENTS

11

ACTIVE

4

ACTIVE CATEGORIES



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (18)

PARTNERSHIP

Palo Alto Networks

2026-07-02

Palo Alto Networks, IBM & Red Hat Expand Project Lightwell

Palo Alto Networks, IBM and Red Hat expanded their Project Lightwell collaboration to help organizations respond faster to software vulnerabilities. The 'shield-and-fix' approach pairs Palo Alto's network-level Virtual Patching with IBM/Red Hat software remediation across open source, commercial apps, OT and healthcare tech. Same-day virtual patches deploy ahead of official fixes, while IBM Consulting helps prioritize high-risk vulnerabilities and validate protections, leveraging IBM's \$5B open-source security commitment.

Source: <https://www.storagenewsletter.com/2026/07/02/ibm-red-hat-and-palo-alto-networks-expand-project-lightwell-to-help-organizations-respond-to-software-vulnerabilities/>

BUSINESS

Palo Alto Networks

2026-07-02

PANW Fast-Track for Israel's TA-35 and TA-125 Indices

Palo Alto Networks announced it will be added to Israel's TA-35 and TA-125 stock indices via fast-track approval, effective August 6, 2026. The move follows the company's February 2026 listing on the Tel Aviv Stock Exchange after its CyberArk acquisition, underscoring its growing strategic weight in Israel's cybersecurity sector.

Source: <https://www.gurufocus.com/news/8943369/palo-alto-networks-panw-fasttracked-for-inclusion-in-israels-ta35-and-ta125-indices>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Palo Alto Networks**

2026-07-02

Cortex XSIAM Adds In-Silicon AI Security via NVIDIA BlueField DPUs

Palo Alto Networks unveiled a new AI security approach using Cortex XSIAM with NVIDIA DOCA Argus, delivering in-silicon threat visibility directly from BlueField DPUs with zero host overhead. The design pushes detection into the network fabric to protect AI infrastructure workloads without impacting compute performance. Markets responded positively, with PANW shares rising roughly 4.3% on the news.

Source: <https://tradersunion.com/news/companies/show/2550895-palo-alto-networks-jumps-4-26percent/>

SECURITY ADVISORY**Cisco**

2026-07-02

Cisco Confirms In-the-Wild Exploitation of Unified CM Flaw

Cisco confirmed active exploitation of CVE-2026-20230, an improper HTTP request validation flaw in Unified Communications Manager and Unified CM SME. The bug enables SSRF and potential arbitrary file writes leading to root access on appliances with WebDialer enabled. Cisco released fixes for 14SU6 and urged immediate upgrades, updating its advisory after initially reporting no known exploitation.

Source: <https://www.securityweek.com/cisco-confirms-in-the-wild-exploitation-of-unified-cm-vulnerability/>

PARTNERSHIP**Cisco**

2026-07-02

Cisco and College Board Launch AP Cybersecurity

Cisco, with the College Board, announced the launch of AP Cybersecurity for the 2026-2027 school year as part of the new AP Career Kickstart program. Cisco Networking Academy provides industry-aligned curriculum, hands-on labs and educator support nationwide. The 2025-2026 pilot reached 3,100 students across 183 schools in 30 states, aiming to address the cybersecurity talent shortage through career-connected learning.

Source: <https://www.3blmedia.com/news/cisco-partners-college-board-launch-ap-cybersecurity-and-expand-career-connected-learning>

BUSINESS**Cisco**

2026-07-02

Cisco to Deploy Personalized AI Agents to All 90,000 Employees

Cisco announced a company-wide rollout of personalized AI agents to all 90,000 employees beginning August 2026. The assistants handle tasks, answer questions, dynamically select the best AI model, and route users to the right tools, with most operations running on Cisco's own servers to control costs and protect data. Early finance use saw AI draft 80-90% of first-draft investor documents.

Source: <https://www.newsbytesapp.com/news/science/cisco-deploying-personalized-ai-agents-to-90000-employees-august-2026/tldr>

BUSINESS**CrowdStrike**

2026-07-02

CrowdStrike 4-for-1 Stock Split Takes Effect

CrowdStrike's first-ever stock split, a 4-for-1 move, took effect July 2, 2026, cutting the share price from about \$772 to roughly \$193 while quadrupling shares outstanding. Executed as a stock dividend to holders of record June 25, the split follows a strong fiscal Q1 2027 with \$1.39B revenue (+26%) and record net-new ARR, and aims to broaden investor accessibility.

Source: <https://www.fool.com/investing/2026/07/02/crowdstrike-just-split-its-stock-4-for-1-does-a-19/>

PARTNERSHIP**Zscaler**

2026-07-02

StarLink Signs Distribution Agreement for Zscaler in Middle East

StarLink, an Infinigate group company, announced a distribution agreement to bring Zscaler's Zero Trust Exchange platform to enterprises across the Middle East. The partnership extends Zscaler's cloud security offerings—secure remote access, web security and data loss prevention—through StarLink's regional partner network, supporting digital transformation and expanding Zscaler's footprint in the region.

Source: <https://techitupme.com/starlink-announces-distribution-agreement-with-zscaler/>

RESEARCH**Check Point Software**

2026-07-02

Check Point Releases 2026 Exposure Gap Report at Engage Paris

Check Point unveiled its 2026 Exposure Gap Report at Check Point Engage in Paris, finding critical vulnerability exposures more than doubled year over year, yet fewer than 1 in 12 required urgent action. Vulnerabilities now make up 42.6% of critical exposures (up from 18.7%), phishing sites surged, and organizations remediated 85.9% of recommended fixes—urging teams to prioritize signal over alert volume.

Source: <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/as-ai-floods-security-teams-with-alerts-new-check-point-exposure-management-research-finds-critical-vulnerabilities-have-doubled-yet-fewer-than-1-in-12-demand-urgent-action-302816720.html>

BUSINESS**Fortinet**

2026-07-02

Fortinet Sets Q2 2026 Earnings Call for July 29

Fortinet announced it will report second-quarter 2026 financial results with a conference call on Wednesday, July 29, 2026 at 1:30 p.m. Pacific Time. A listen-only webcast, prepared remarks, slides and a replay will be available on Fortinet's investor relations site.

Source: <https://www.stocktitan.net/news/FTNT/fortinet-to-announce-second-quarter-2026-financial-v6o7d9hbbr10.html>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Cloudflare**

2026-07-02

Cloudflare Launches Monetization Gateway with x402

Cloudflare announced the Monetization Gateway, letting customers charge for any resource behind Cloudflare—web pages, datasets, APIs and MCP tools—through a single control plane for payment and access policies. Payments settle in stablecoins via the open x402 protocol with sub-second, edge-based settlement and no checkout redirects. It supports programmable access rules and agent payments via Web Bot Auth, with an early-access waitlist now open.

Source: <https://blog.cloudflare.com/monetization-gateway/>

PRODUCT UPDATE**Cloudflare**

2026-07-02

Cloudflare Overhauls AI Crawler Controls by Function

Cloudflare introduced new AI crawler controls that let site owners manage bot traffic by function—Search, Agent and Training—rather than a binary allow/block. From September 15, 2026, new domains will block Training and Agent crawlers by default on ad-bearing pages while allowing Search. Cloudflare also expanded Pay Per Crawl to Pay Per Use and added content-use controls and transitive-trust attribution to build a monetizable agentic internet.

Source: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/07/02/cloudflare-ai-crawler-controls/>

PRODUCT UPDATE**AWS**

2026-07-02

AWS Config Adds Support for 8 New Resource Types

AWS announced AWS Config now supports eight additional resource types spanning API Gateway, EC2, S3 and other services, including VpcLink, VPCEncryptionControl, NetworkFirewall, ContainerAssociation, OpenSearchServerless, SecurityPolicy, and S3Vectors VectorBucket. Accounts recording all resource types automatically begin tracking the new types, which are available in Config rules and aggregators, enhancing discovery, auditing and remediation across regions.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/06/aws-config-new-resource-types/>

PRODUCT UPDATE**AWS**

2026-07-02

AWS Raises Bedrock AgentCore Runtime Quotas up to 5x

AWS significantly increased Bedrock AgentCore runtime quotas to help enterprises scale AI agents. Active concurrent sessions rise to 5,000 in US East/West (2,500 elsewhere), token throughput jumps from 25 to 200 tokens/second across all regions, and container session-creation rate climbs to 400 transactions per minute. The changes apply automatically to enterprise accounts, easing deployment delays during peak AI-agent demand.

Source: <https://www.infoworld.com/article/4192220/aws-raises-agentcore-runtime-quotas-by-up-to-5x-to-help-enterprises-scale-ai-agents.html>

ACQUISITION**Akamai**

2026-07-02

Akamai Completes \$205M Acquisition of LayerX

Akamai completed its roughly \$205 million acquisition of secure enterprise browser provider LayerX. The deal adds in-browser visibility and control over how users interact with web content, prompts, file uploads and SaaS apps, expanding Akamai's Zero Trust portfolio (segmentation, ZTNA, DNS security) and adding AI-usage governance. LayerX, founded in 2022, is expected to reach about \$10M ARR by year-end and continues Akamai's Israeli expansion.

Source: <https://www.stocktitan.net/news/AKAM/akamai-completes-acquisition-of-secure-enterprise-browser-provider-8btb0a0alj7.html>

PARTNERSHIP**Akamai**

2026-07-02

Akamai and NVIDIA Embed Zero Trust in AI Factories

Akamai and NVIDIA announced a collaboration to embed zero-trust security into AI factories. The initiative integrates Akamai Guardicore Segmentation with NVIDIA Vera BlueField-4 STX storage on the NVIDIA DOCA platform, enabling workload-based segmentation, agent-behavior monitoring and threat blocking at the infrastructure layer without impacting AI compute performance—protecting data, context memory and autonomous agents in high-speed AI workloads.

Source: <https://www.digitaltoday.co.kr/en/view/77382/akamai-teams-up-with-nvidia-to-embed-zero-trust-security-in-ai-factories>

SECURITY ADVISORY**Citrix (NetScaler)**

2026-07-02

Citrix Patches Six NetScaler Flaws, Including 'HTTP/2 Bomb'

Citrix issued a security bulletin for six vulnerabilities in NetScaler ADC and NetScaler Gateway, including the new HTTP/2 Bomb DoS flaw (CVE-2026-13474) and a CitrixBleed-class memory-disclosure bug (CVE-2026-8451) tied to SAML IdP parsing. CVSS scores range from 6.9 to 8.8. Fixes shipped in 14.1-72.61 and 13.1-63.18; Citrix urges immediate patching, with a manual config change needed for the HTTP/2 issue.

Source: <https://cyberscoop.com/citrix-netscaler-flaw-cve-2026-8451-citrixbleed/>

PRODUCT UPDATE

HPE / Juniper Networks 2026-07-02

HPE Expands Self-Driving Networks, Unifies Juniper Mist & Aruba

HPE expanded its self-driving networks strategy, integrating Juniper Mist with Aruba Central into a unified Marvis roadmap spanning edge, campus and data center. Mist now supports HPE Networking CX wired switches, while Aruba Central gains AI insights and self-healing automation. HPE emphasized zero-trust-by-design and generative AI/agent operations to optimize performance, security and user experience across AI infrastructure, announced at a Seoul media briefing.

Source: <https://www.chosun.com/english/industry-en/2026/07/02/36S22BAA6RH2RNTYIRSLS3RCHM/>